

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Would you recommend me?



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs, professions and careers.
- I can write about my experiences.
- I can write about my academic studies and my work in various time frames.

Ask your partner:

- What words would you use to describe your skills and attributes? Hard-working? Motivated?
- Do you think it is important to remain professional and polite when you quit a job? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Julian Parker agreed to provide Adam with a letter of reference. Will his opinion of Adam help shape this **budding*** senior editor's career?

* "Budding" means being in an early developmental stage.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

To Whom It May Concern:

I am writing to provide a personal reference for Adam Bari. In my experience as the editor of *The News Gazette*, I have had the pleasure of working with many talented young people who are looking to enter the industry. Adam Bari ranks among the very best young reporters I have encountered. Working in a range of positions early in his career after achieving his degree, he has developed an impressive portfolio of work and dynamic work ethic. Furthermore, I can state with confidence that he is a highly motivated and responsible person with a high degree of integrity.

His ability to seamlessly communicate the written word to readers transcends age, education and reading preference. While consistently demonstrating a desire to provide carefully researched and unbiased reporting, he has developed a keen sense of justice when it comes to covering events and issues related to the human experience. Having developed strong communication skills in the workplace, he has mastered the ability to inspire respect and cooperation in co-workers, despite his limited years in the field. Taking a page out of my book and not shying away from asking hard questions and receiving constructive feedback, he has quickly emerged as a 'shining light' amongst recent graduates.

After congratulating Adam on his recent piece in a local magazine, I was informed that he wished to pursue an editorial assistant position. I feel that this is an appropriate choice for him. Having already observed his commitment to excellence, I feel he clearly has an interest in excelling in the publishing field. He has the ability to achieve great success. I sincerely hope that you give his application favorable consideration.

If you need any further information about Adam's time at *The News Gazette*, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

Julian Parker



Let's Practice!

Julian describes Adam's professional background. Adam isn't interested in doing nothing with his life.

Instructions: Proofread the text below. Circle the incorrect words. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Working in a range of positions early in his career after achieving his degree, he having develops an impressive portfolio of work and dynamic work ethic.
2. Adam aren't interests in doing nothing with his life.
3. Having developed strong communications skills in the workplace, he has mastery the ability to inspire respect and cooperation in co-workers, despite his limited years in the field.
4. Taking a leaf out of my book and not shying away from asking hard questions and receiving constructive feedback, he had quick emerging as a 'shining lights' amongst recent graduates.
5. After congratulating Adam on his recent piece in a local magazine, I was informed that he washed two pursue an editorial assistant position.



Let's Practice!

Now, it's your turn to write about professions, jobs and careers. What would your boss say about you?

Instructions:

- *What do you think your boss would write about you in a letter of reference?*
- *Imagine you have to write a letter of reference about yourself.*
- *Use the letter of reference on page 2 as a guide.*
- *What would you write about your education, experience and work ethic?*
- *Go to the learning points section to review the structure of "Writing a recommendation letter".*

My Letter of Reference





Extension Activity

Time to learn more about a friend's career path.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 150-170 word letter of reference about a friend.
- First, interview a friend about their education and past jobs.
- Ask them to talk about their experiences.
- Talk about their work ethic, dedication to their job and future goals.
- Write notes based on the interview. Be sure to ask lots of questions.
- Read the letter of reference aloud to friend when completed.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I interview a friend about their education, work experience and future goals.

☐ ☐

I take notes based on a conversation about work.

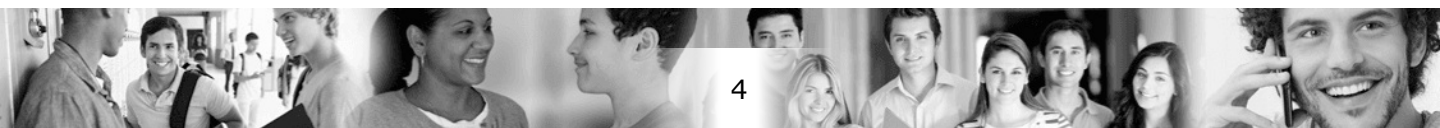
☐ ☐

I write a letter of reference for a friend.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to rank** (verb): amount or degree
e.g. Adam Bari ranks among the very best young reporters.
- to encounter** (verb): to meet someone without expecting or intending to
e.g. I have encountered a number of talented graduates.
- integrity** (noun): the quality of being honest and fair
e.g. Furthermore, I can confidently state that he is a highly motivated and responsible person with a true sense of integrity.
- portfolio** (noun): a selection of work
e.g. He has developed an impressive portfolio of work and dynamic work ethic.
- seamlessly** (adverb): moving from one thing to another easily and without any interruptions or problems
e.g. His ability to seamlessly communicate the written word to readers transcends age, education and reading preference.
- keen** (adjective): very strong and sensitive
e.g. He has developed a keen sense of fairness when it comes to covering events and issues related to the human experience.
- justice** (noun): the process or result of using laws to fairly judge and punish
e.g. He believes there needs to be justice for all.
- to shy away from** (expression): to not face something
e.g. By not shying away from asking hard questions and receiving constructive feedback, he has quickly emerged as a 'shining light' among recent graduates.
- field** (noun): an area of work or study
e.g. He has the ability to inspire respect and cooperation in co-workers, despite his limited years in the field.
- to transcend** (verb): to rise above or go beyond the normal limits of
e.g. He is able to transcend his own issues and help others.





Learning Points

Expressing Reason: *-ing* Clauses

You can use *-ing* clauses to express reason.

A clause is a part of a sentence with its own subject and verb. You can use verb+*ing* in a clause to express reason, relationships, or to explain *why* something happened. It also allows you to be very specific about the relationship between the two clauses.

For example:

*When I was a boy, publishers came running after you, **hoping to find someone who could put a sentence together.***

This is an alternative to using typical words like *because* and *since* to give the reason.

For example, instead of saying

*When I was a boy, publishers came running after me **since** they hoped to find someone who could put a sentence together.*

You can use the sentence above.

Varying your style of writing and speech is beneficial in workplace setting as it gives you and your ideas a more dynamic feel and livens up otherwise simplistic language.

Examples:

- ***Having developed strong communication skills in the workplace***, he has mastered the ability to inspire respect and cooperation in co-workers, despite his limited years in the field.
- Adam isn't interested in ***doing nothing with his life.***
- After ***congratulating Adam on his recent piece a local magazine***, he informed me that he wished to pursue an editorial assistant position.
- ***Working in a range of positions early in his career after achieving his degree***, he has developed an impressive portfolio of work and dynamic work ethic.





Learning Points

How to Write a *Recommendation Letter*

A *letter of recommendation* is a document in which the writer summarizes the qualities, characteristics, and capabilities of a person they know.

1. First, use formal language. A letter of recommendation is a professional communication.
2. The sender's address goes at the top right next to the date.
3. Add the recipient's name (if known) and their address on the top left.
4. Begin the letter with a formal greeting like, Dear Sir/Madam (if you don't know the recipient's name) or Dear Mr. Black,

Summarize your message. Explain how well you know the person and how you met him or her. Include your personal qualifications.

Identify the person's responsibilities and accomplishments while they were working with you. Using specific examples when possible.

Repeat your recommendation at the end of the letter. Invite the reader to contact you with further questions.

Read the following examples of sentences you would find in a recommendation letter.

Examples:

- *In my experience as the editor of The News Gazette, I have had the pleasure of working with many talented young people who are looking to enter the industry.*
- *Adam Bari ranks among the very best young reporters I have encountered.*
- *If you need any further information about Adam's time at The News Gazette, please do not hesitate to contact me.*

